

Obtain a Throat Culture**081-833-0248**

Conditions: You have a patient that requires a throat culture. You will need the patient's clinical records, gloves, tongue blades, penlight, sterile cotton-tipped swabs, sterile culture tube with transport medium (or commercial collection kit), label(s), laboratory request form, SF 510 Nursing Notes and a laboratory biohazard transport bag. You have performed a patient care hand wash and are not in a CBRN environment.

Standards: Obtain a throat culture without causing injury to the patient.

Performance Steps

1. Explain the procedure to the patient and provide privacy.

NOTE: Tell the patient that they may gag during the swabbing, but that the procedure will probably take less than one minute.

2. Instruct the patient to sit erect at the edge of the bed or in a chair, facing you.
3. Put on gloves.
4. Ask the patient to tilt their head back.
5. Instruct the patient to open their mouth.
6. Depress the patient's tongue with the tongue blade.

NOTE: If the patient starts to gag, withdraw the tongue blade and tell them to breathe deeply. After they relax, reinsert the tongue blade carefully.

7. Illuminate the patient's throat with the penlight to check for inflamed areas.

WARNING: Do not touch the tongue, cheeks or teeth as this will contaminate the specimen with oral bacteria.

8. Swab patient's tonsillar areas with a cotton-tipped swab from side to side to include any inflamed or purulent sites.

9. Withdraw the swab and immediately place it in the culture tube.

NOTE: If you are using a commercial kit, crush the ampule of culture medium at the bottom of the tube and then push the swab into the medium to keep the swab moist.

10. Remove and discard gloves.
11. Label the specimen.
 - a. Patient's name.
 - b. Date of birth.
 - c. Medical officer requesting culture.
 - d. Date.
 - e. Time.
 - f. Site of collection.
12. Fill out laboratory request form appropriately.
13. Place culture in a laboratory biohazard transport bag.

14. Send or take the specimen to the laboratory immediately to prevent growth or deterioration of microbes.

15. Record procedure on SF 510.

Evaluation Preparation:

Setup: For training and evaluation, use another Soldier to act as the patient.

Brief Soldier: Tell the Soldier the patient requires a throat culture to be taken.

Performance Measures	GO	NO GO
1 Explained the procedure and provided privacy.	_____	_____
2 Instructed the patient to sit erect facing you.	_____	_____
3 Put on gloves.	_____	_____
4 Asked the patient to tilt their head back.	_____	_____
5 Instructed the patient to open their mouth.	_____	_____
6 Depressed the patient's tongue with the tongue blade.	_____	_____
7 Illuminated the patient's throat with the penlight to check for inflamed areas.	_____	_____
8 Swabbed patient's tonsillar areas with a cotton-tipped swab from side to side to include any inflamed or purulent areas.	_____	_____
9 Withdrew the swab and placed immediately in the culture tube.	_____	_____
10 Removed and discarded gloves.	_____	_____
11 Labeled the specimen correctly.	_____	_____
12 Filled out laboratory request form appropriately.	_____	_____
13 Placed culture in a laboratory biohazard transport bag.	_____	_____
14 Sent or took specimen to the laboratory immediately to prevent growth or deterioration of microbes.	_____	_____
15 Recorded procedure on SF 510.	_____	_____

Evaluation Guidance: Score each Soldier according to the performance measures. Unless otherwise stated in the task summary, the Soldier must pass all performance measures to be scored GO. If the Soldier fails any steps, show what was done wrong and how to do it correctly.

References

Required
SF 510

Related
None